

LONDON BUSINESS SCHOOL

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT THE SCHOOL

On the heels of its new curriculum debut in 2017, London Business School touts itself as "the world's most flexible MBA." Just as London has become one of the world's great cities, so London Business School has transformed into one of the world's finest business schools.

A top-flight center of teaching and research, the school's MBA program often ranks #1 in Europe, and is seen as the international alternative to the finance-focused business schools of the US. Blue-chip firms from consultancy to finance to industry fight to recruit 400 graduates every year, for placement in positions not only in the UK and Europe, but also in the Middle East, Africa and Asia.

The culture and economy of London are at the heart of the LBS experience, and the student body reflects such a cosmopolitan city with more than 70 nationalities in the MBA classroom. LBS admissions is looking for a diverse but balanced class, with no dominant culture.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

Finance, Strategy, Entrepreneurship, Global Business Experience, Real Estate, Media, Marketing, Energy. Career placement and deep roots in international financial markets

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	1	-	3	-	1	2	2	3
Financial Times	1	1	1	2	3	3	2	2
Forbes	-	4	-	1	-	1	-	1
The Economist	3	3	3	24	25	7	6	6

CLASS OF 2021

Number of Applicants	2452
MBA Class Size	485
Yield	60%
Total Tuition	£82,000

ADMISSIONS

Avg Age	29
Avg GMAT	708
Female Students	39%
Admissions Selectivity	33%

POST-MBA CAREERS

Financial Services	37%
Consulting	23%
Technology	23%
Consumer / Retail	6%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

McKinsey, BCG, Bain, Strategy&, Deloitte, AT Kearney, Amazon, Accenture

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$106,120

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 93%

**Rankings are relative to other European business schools that appeared in at least three of the four major media rankings. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.*



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR LONDON BUSINESS SCHOOL APPLICATION

BY EMMA BOND

As a senior member of London Business School's MBA admissions committee, Emma was responsible for full-time MBA selection and marketing. In addition to reviewing thousands of applications she also developed and allocated the program's scholarship portfolio. Emma subsequently joined The Boston Consulting Group's London office, managing LBS' talent pipeline into the company's global offices and recruiting undergraduates from Oxford and Cambridge universities.



At LBS, 'global' is more than just a word - it's a culture that is woven through the fabric of the entire institution.

1

APPLY EARLY (IF YOU CAN)

It's definitely preferable to apply for R1 or R2. While European business schools have a more even distribution of places across the different rounds compared to the top US schools, LBS often uses R4 to complete its class with the desired number of UK candidates. By rounds 3 and 4 there are far fewer spots left, most having been dished out to the strong, well-prepared candidates who applied in Rounds 1 and 2. In addition, if you wait until later rounds you will also be running up against waitlisted candidates from earlier rounds – the waitlist is reviewed regularly throughout the year and then again before each admission offer point.

COMMUNICATE YOUR CONTRIBUTION

2

LBS' students are very active in community-related events – social, sports, and clubs. The Admissions team is looking for candidates who will participate and lead these activities enthusiastically and contribute beyond as alumni. So, you need to have demonstrated similar energy and dedication to activities outside of your professional life. Admissions will want to understand how you will play a role on-campus and how you envision contributing; this is where the value of visiting LBS and knowing it well will also pay off. The more specific and authentic you can be, the better.

3

IT'S OKAY NOT TO BE INTERESTED IN FINANCE

LBS has a strong tradition in finance, supported by its superb position close to the City of London, top finance faculty, and exceptional links with global finance recruiters. But ongoing rankings success has ensured that the admissions pipeline, and consequently graduate career choice, is becoming increasingly diverse. LBS now has a stable in and out pipeline from top consulting firms like BCG and McKinsey, while tech recruiters like Amazon and Google have become increasingly visible on campus. So don't be afraid to explore and sell yourself on less traditional career paths. Just be realistic about your aims and remember to reference transferable skills from your job.

CONVEY YOUR PASSION FOR THE SCHOOL

4

As one of the leading business schools in Europe, LBS competes with INSEAD to offer career opportunities in the corporate sector, consulting, technology and media. For applicants looking to move ahead in finance, it also competes with top US schools.

In this competitive environment, the admissions office is constantly looking for evidence of your commitment to the school. If at all possible, try to visit LBS before you submit your application. The admissions team offers a number of options for candidates; in addition to monthly London Information Sessions, you can also attend a 'drop-in' session each week or book in to take part in a class. If you manage to speak with one of the admissions team it may get you on their radar as a strong candidate, and it means you can include your visit on the application form, which in turn helps reinforce your commitment to the school. If you can't visit campus, try and attend one of the many Information Sessions LBS holds in different countries around the world each year.

5

GLOBAL IS NOT JUST A WORD; IT'S A CULTURE

There's no doubt that LBS is a truly international business school. It's based in a supremely multicultural city, and less than 10% of the class is British. But at LBS, global is more than just a word – it's a culture that is woven through the fabric of the entire institution. The school is continually reinventing the curriculum to best represent this focus, most recently including the Global Business Experiences immersion week as part of its core MBA offering. So it's no longer enough just to state confidently that you've backpacked across Europe – the admissions committee will be closely scrutinizing your application to see exactly what global flavor you'll bring to the new class. Internationalism can take many forms. Have you worked on international projects or liaised often with international clients? Do you work on multi-cultural teams? Have you invested time in learning other languages? Are there any global secondment opportunities coming up at your company?

Any and all of these things can add weight to your application. Serious LBS applicants will have worked, lived and travelled on multiple continents, so if the international aspect of the LBS experience is what drew you to the school in the first place, make sure you sell that side of yourself. Getting across your passion for travel, for experiencing other cultures and for working in a global capacity post-graduation is crucial. And if you are thinking about applying to LBS in a year or two and have not yet travelled, get out there and do it!

ESSAY ANALYSIS

The very best answers give the Admissions Committee context into what has motivated your post-MBA career goals and whose lives will be different (and how) if you succeed.



ESSAY 1. "What are your post-MBA plans and how will your prior experience and the London Business School programme contribute towards these?" (500 words)

This question pulls no punches – it asks exactly what it's looking for, and doesn't make you read between the lines – but its seeming simplicity is actually what makes it so tricky. At a minimum, you need to make a compelling case for needing an MBA to achieve your professional goals and demonstrate how London Business School is uniquely positioned to help get you there. The very best answers to this question go a little deeper, giving the Admissions Committee context into what has motivated your post-MBA career goals; showing an advanced level of self-awareness that includes identifying any skills gaps and a clear understanding of how LBS can help you overcome them.

Like all schools, LBS wants to see you've done your homework, and they'll want you to showcase more in-depth knowledge of the program and community than you can glean from a quick review of their website. This is your opportunity to showcase your school research and show your LBS love. So, think about what specific classes, professors, clubs or other on and off campus initiatives will factor into your success.

ESSAY 2. (Optional) Is there any other information you believe the Admissions Committee should know about you and your application to London Business School? (500 words)”

In many business school applications, the optional essay needs to be used to explain poor academic performance, like less than stellar undergraduate performance or a low GMAT. However, London Business School asks you about your prior academic performance specifically in their application form. If you have another weakness you’re concerned about – perhaps you were fired from a job, or took an extended career break – you should use this section to explain that.

Otherwise, use this section to further make the case for your candidacy by highlighting another aspect of your profile that makes you a great fit for LBS. Perhaps you have another passion, not directly related to your career goals. This is your chance to tell the committee what you’ve done with that passion, and what you’ll do to share it with the community, showcasing your leadership, team skills and/or international outlook along the way. Great examples have included a candidate who had overcome learning disabilities and wanted to help connect learning disabled students at LBS with the resources to help them succeed on the program, an amateur photographer who had organized exhibitions who wanted to revive the LBS photography club, and an LGBTQ+ rights advocate who had been a senior organizer of his city’s Pride parade who wanted to take a leadership role within the OiB club on campus.

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	INTERVIEW INVITATIONS	FINAL DECISIONS
Round 1	11 September 2020	08 October 2020	19 November 2020
Round 2	05 January 2021	09 February 2021	31 March 2021
Round 3	04 March 2021	14 April 2021	25 May 2021
Round 4	27 April 2021	18 May 2021	22 June 2021



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

